

THE PLAN OF SALVATION

"What will you do with Jesus?"

Primary Text: Acts 2:36-42 | Sermon Type: Topical | Length: 30 minutes

PROPOSITION:	God has revealed through the gospel how sinners come to Christ: they hear His Word, believe in Jesus Christ, repent of sin, confess Christ, are baptized into Christ, and thereafter live in faithful obedience to Him.
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INTRODUCTION - GOD'S WORK COMES FIRST

A. Salvation Begins with God, Not Man.

- John 3:16 - "God so loved the world, that he gave..."
- Romans 5:8 - "while we were yet sinners, Christ died for us."
- Ephesians 2:4-5 - "God, who is rich in mercy, for his great love..."
- Ephesians 2:8-9 - "For by grace are ye saved through faith..."
- Titus 2:11-12 - "the grace of God that bringeth salvation... Teaching us..."

B. The Biblical Order of Salvation.

- 1. God loved. 2. Christ died. 3. The gospel was revealed. 4. The gospel is preached.
- 5. Man responds. 6. God saves. 7. The Christian faithfully follows Christ.

C. The Great Commission Establishes the Pattern.

- Matthew 28:18-20 - Make disciples; baptize them; teach them to observe Christ's commands.
- Mark 16:15-16 - Preach the gospel; the believing and baptized person is promised salvation.
- Luke 24:46-47 - Christ suffered and arose; repentance and remission are preached beginning at Jerusalem.

D. Acts 2 Puts the Commission into Practice.

Peter preached Christ - His life, crucifixion, resurrection, exaltation, and lordship. The hearers were convicted and asked, "What shall we do?"

KEY THOUGHT:	The six responses are not six human works by which we save ourselves. They are our divinely commanded response to what God has already accomplished through Jesus Christ.
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→ What will you do with Jesus?

SERMON ROADMAP

Hear His Word. Believe His Son. Repent of Sin. Confess His Name. Be Baptized into Christ. Obey Him Faithfully.

I. HEAR HIS WORD

Romans 10:17 - *"faith cometh by hearing..."*

- A. Faith requires revelation - **Romans 10:14**: "how shall they believe in him of whom they have not heard?"
- B. The gospel must be preached and heard before biblical faith can exist.
- C. **1 Corinthians 15:3-4** - the message centers on Christ's death, burial, and resurrection.

Preach Jesus: Jesus died. Jesus was buried. Jesus arose. Jesus reigns.

→ **HEAR HIS WORD.**

II. BELIEVE HIS SON

John 8:24 - *"if ye believe not that I am he, ye shall die in your sins."*

- A. Biblical faith is more than intellectual acknowledgment.
- B. **James 2:19** - "the devils also believe, and tremble."
- C. Biblical faith trusts Christ enough to respond to Him.
- D. Hebrews 11 demonstrates active faith: Abel offered; Noah prepared; Abraham obeyed.

→ **BELIEVE HIS SON.**

III. REPENT OF SIN

Acts 17:30 - *God "commandeth all men every where to repent."*

- A. **Luke 13:3** - "except ye repent, ye shall all likewise perish."
- B. Repentance is more than sorrow.
- C. **2 Corinthians 7:10** - "godly sorrow worketh repentance..."
- D. Sorrow recognizes sin; repentance changes the mind and direction.

Acts 2:38 places repentance directly in Peter's answer to convicted gospel hearers.

→ **REPENT OF SIN.**

KEY INSIGHT:

The gospel is one integrated response to one gospel of Jesus Christ - not six disconnected religious acts.

ACTS CONVERSION PATTERN

Acts 2: Heard → convicted → repented → baptized → continued steadfastly.

Acts 8: Christ preached → believed → baptized.

Acts 16: Word preached → believed → baptized immediately.

Acts 18:8: "hearing believed, and were baptized."

IV. CONFESS HIS NAME

Matthew 10:32 - "Whosoever therefore shall confess me before men..."

- A. **Romans 10:9** - "confess with thy mouth the Lord Jesus..."
- B. Confession is not merely repeating a ceremonial sentence.
- C. It openly acknowledges who Jesus is: the Christ, the Son of God, and Lord.
- D. Faith in the heart becomes allegiance openly acknowledged.

→ **CONFESS HIS NAME.**

V. BE BAPTIZED INTO CHRIST

Galatians 3:27 - "baptized into Christ have put on Christ."

- A. Notice the direction: **INTO CHRIST.**
- B. **Romans 6:3-4** - baptized into His death; buried with Him; raised to walk in newness of life.
- C. **Acts 2:38** - "Repent, and be baptized... for the remission of sins."
- D. **Acts 22:16** - "arise, and be baptized, and wash away thy sins..."
- E. **1 Peter 3:21** - baptism is connected with salvation through the resurrection of Jesus Christ.

Baptism is not trusting in water. It is trusting Christ's saving work enough to obey His command.

→ **BE BAPTIZED INTO CHRIST.**

VI. OBEY HIM FAITHFULLY

Acts 2:41-42 - "were baptized... continued stedfastly..."

- A. Baptism is not the finish line; it is the beginning of Christian life.
- B. **Matthew 28:20** - baptized disciples are taught "to observe all things."
- C. **Hebrews 5:9** - Christ is "the author of eternal salvation unto all them that obey him."
- D. **Revelation 2:10** - "be thou faithful unto death..."

The Christian life: Saved → Transformed → Serving → Growing → Enduring → Faithful.

→ **OBEY HIM FAITHFULLY.**

CONCLUSION - WHAT WILL YOU DO WITH JESUS?

The question is not, "Do you know the six steps?" One may memorize six steps and never surrender to Christ.

Will you hear His Word? Believe His Son? Repent of sin? Confess His name? Be baptized into Christ? Obey Him faithfully?

GOSPEL INVITATION:	God provided the grace. Christ provided the blood. The Spirit revealed the Word. The gospel provides the message. Now make the response God commands.
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→ **HEAR HIS WORD. BELIEVE HIS SON. REPENT OF SIN. CONFESS HIS NAME. BE BAPTIZED INTO CHRIST. OBEY HIM FAITHFULLY.**

→ **What will you do with Jesus?**